

The Need For Speed - AccelerateR-ing R Adoption in GSK

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Learning and change is hard with pressing deadlines.

A lot of people learn by doing.

How do organizations enable people to learn by doing with pressing deadlines?





Director of Data Science in GSK Biostatistics

Lead R Enablement

**Passionate about learning
and teaching**

What does a Biostatistics Organization do?

**In 2020 GSK Biostatistics decided to
make R a primary language for
statistical reporting**

GSK Biostatistics established a center of excellence for R users. Its purpose was to innovate and teach individuals how to use R for clinical trials and ensure the best practices in the industry. One program in this center of excellence, after a lot failures, became focused on support and mentoring.

It succeeded.

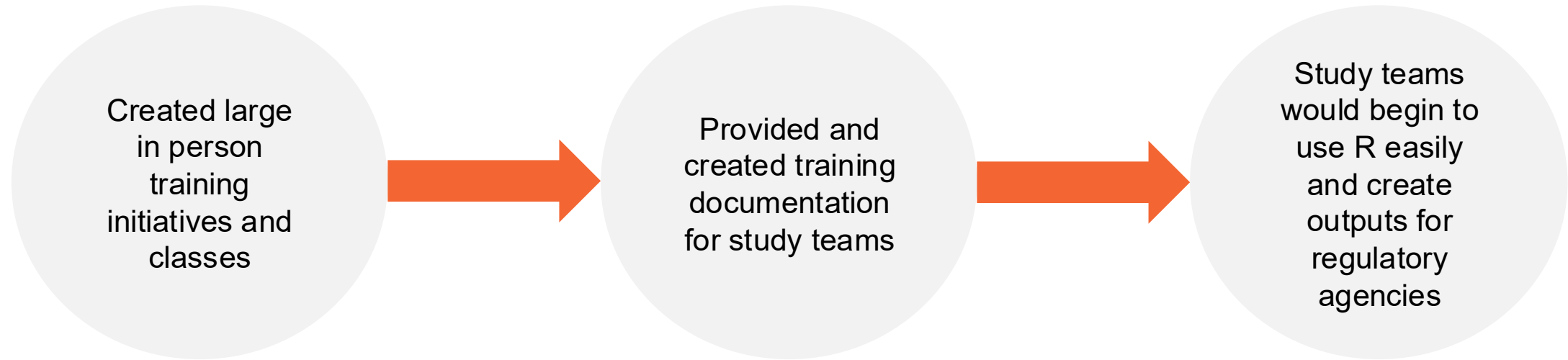
Today GSK Biostatistics call it:

AccelerateR



Started training in large in person and virtual classes because that's what we knew and how we did it last time



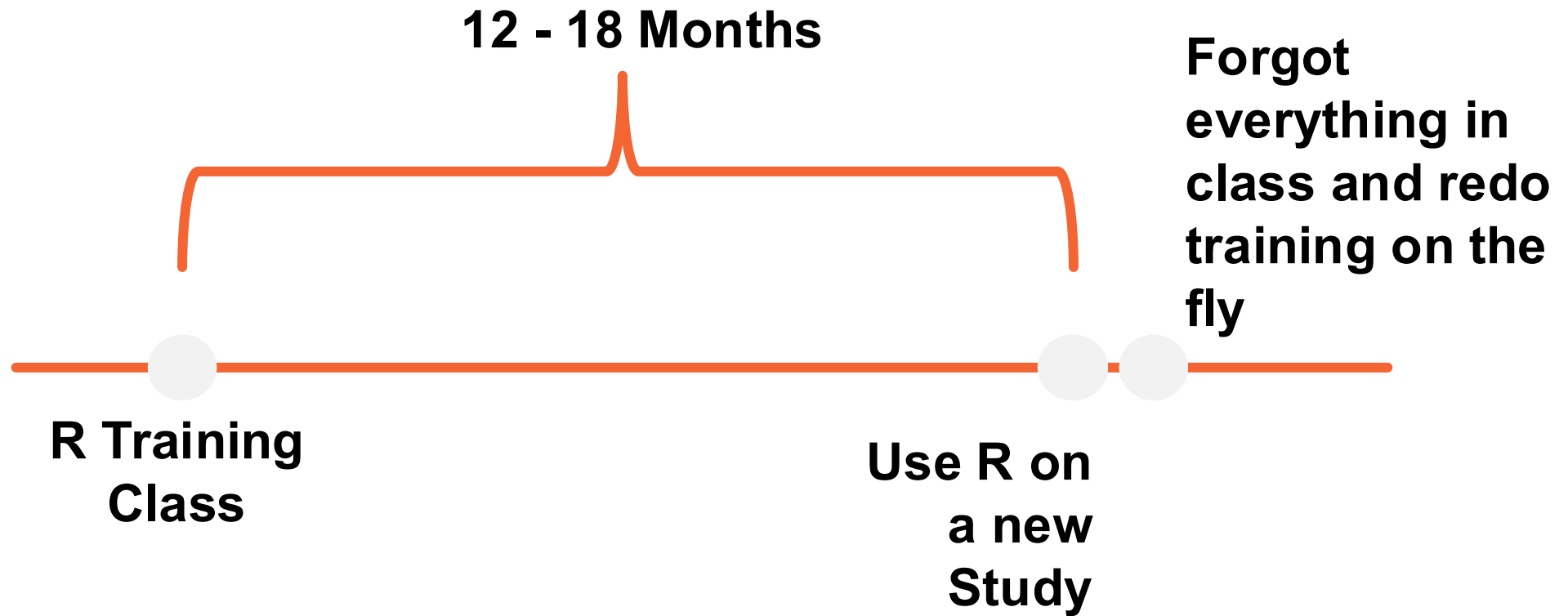


It wasn't working



**We decided to reflect on
what was wrong and why
adoption was so hard**





Learning a huge number of new things as part of R Training

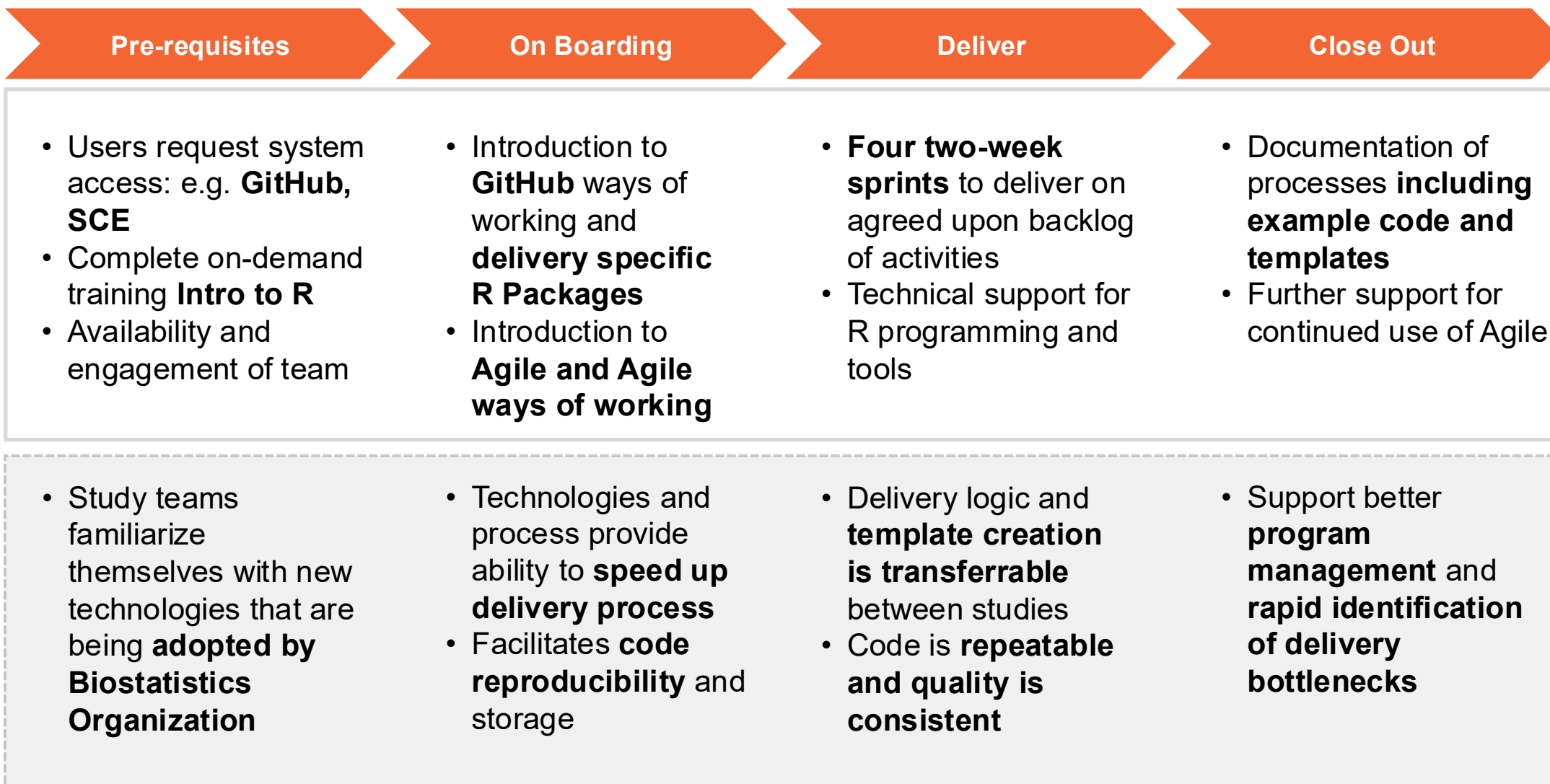
Proposed a change to the Biostatistics Leadership Team

No more classes. Move all our training into on demand training and documentation.

Created the AccelerateR team that is small agile pod that sits side by side with study teams to train them on R.

AccelerateR is focused on supporting and mentoring individuals in Biostatistics.







Impact

Pre-requisites

- Users request system access: e.g. **GitHub, SCE**
- Complete on-demand training **Intro to R**
- Availability and engagement of team

- Study teams familiarize themselves with new technologies that are being **adopted by Biostatistics Organization**

On Boarding

- Introduction to **GitHub** ways of working and **delivery specific R Packages**
- Introduction to **Agile and Agile ways of working**

- Technologies and process provide ability to **speed up delivery process**
- Facilitates **code reproducibility** and storage

Deliver

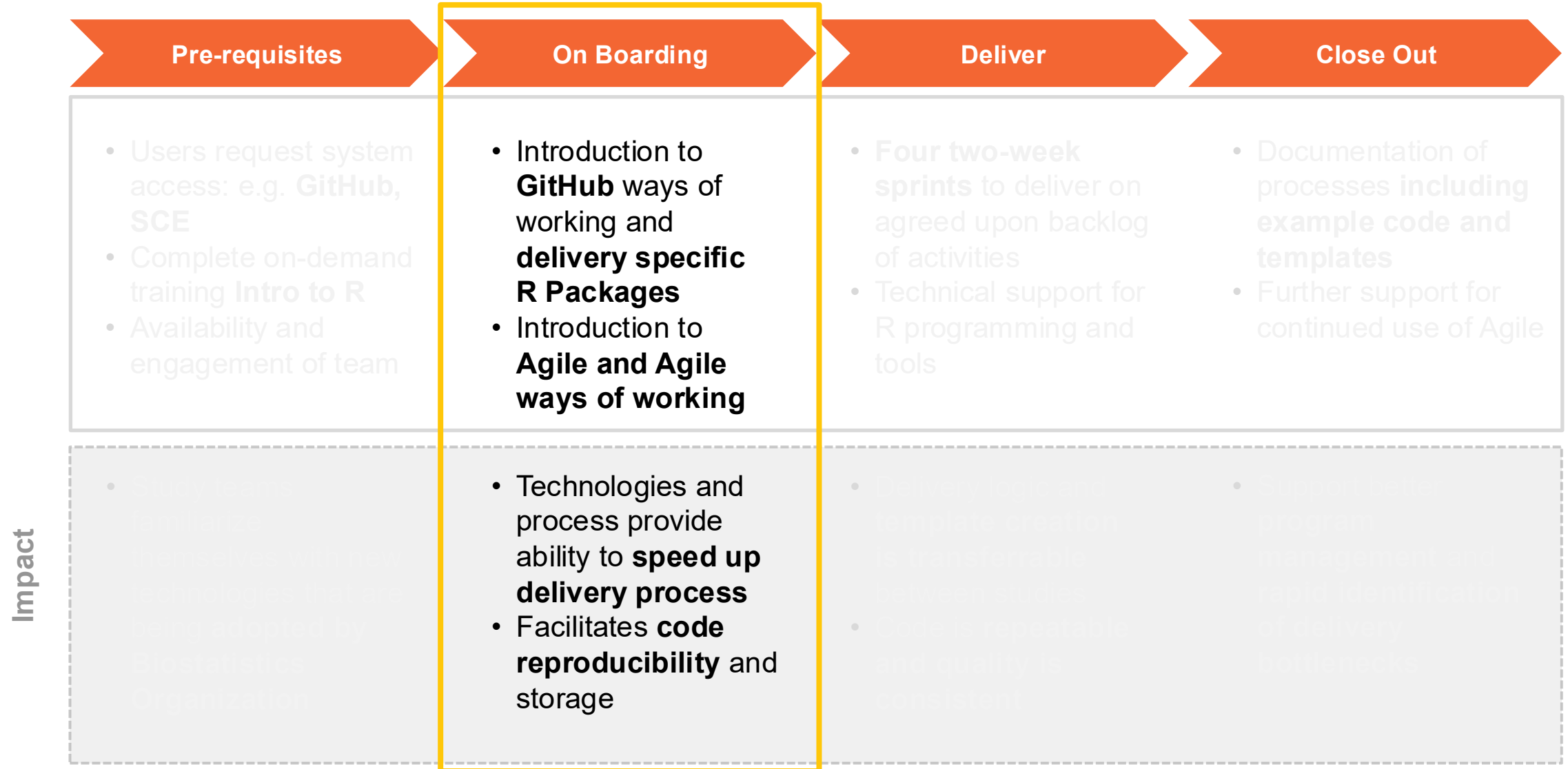
- **Four two-week sprints** to deliver on agreed upon backlog of activities
- Technical support for R programming and tools

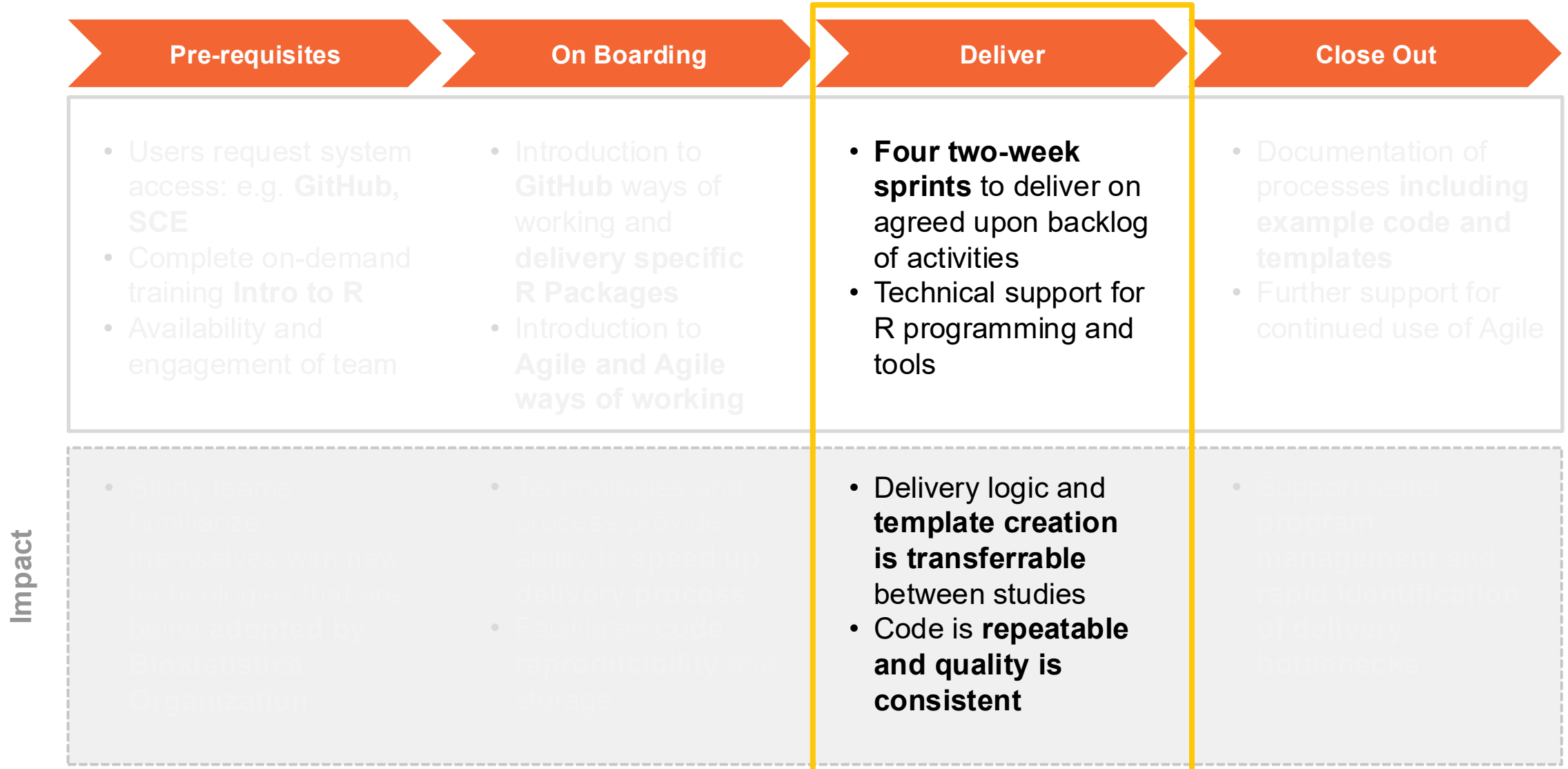
- Delivery logic and **template creation is transferrable** between studies
- Code is **repeatable and quality is consistent**

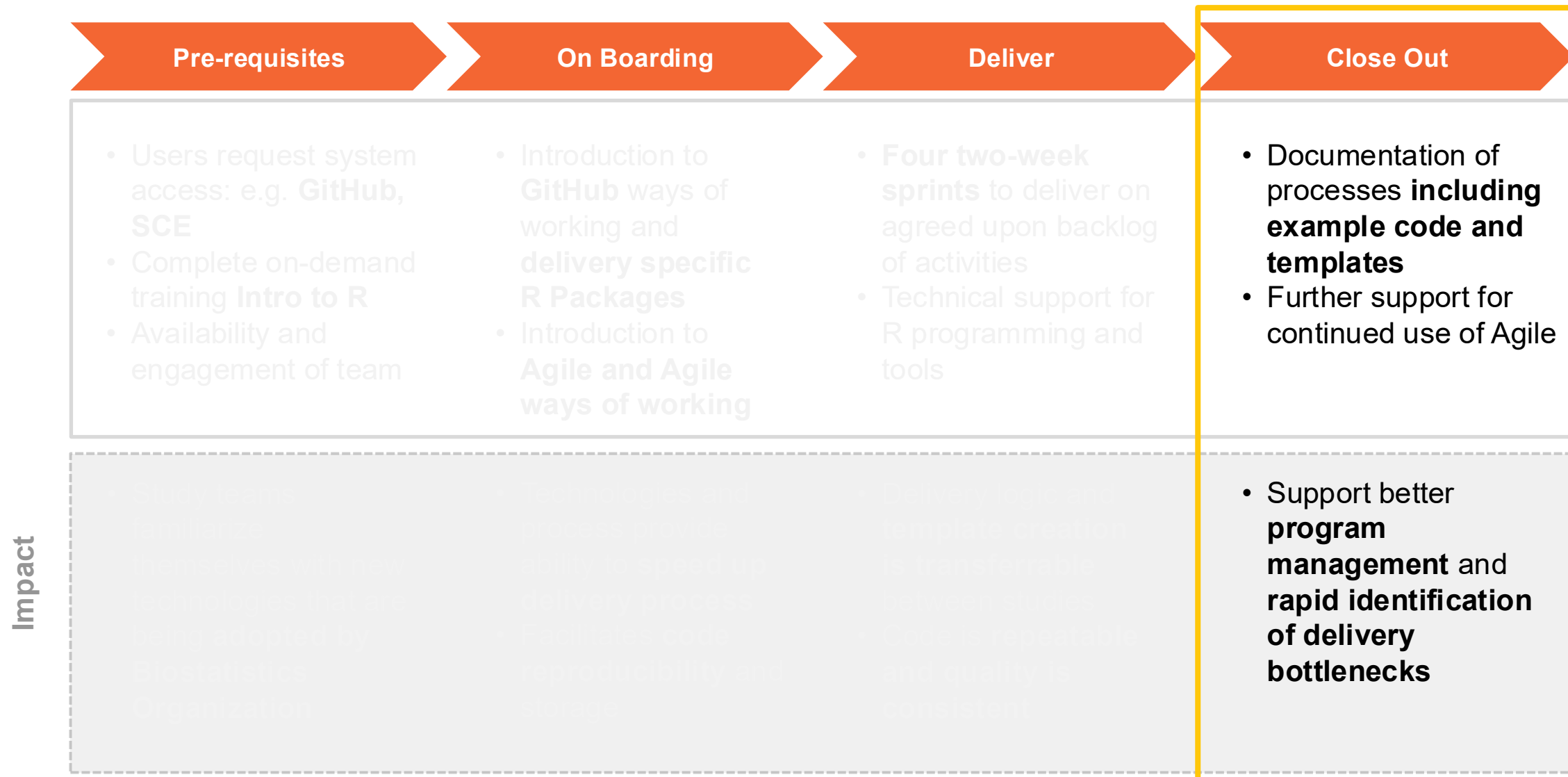
Close Out

- Documentation of processes **including example code and templates**
- Further support for continued use of Agile tools

- Support better **program management** and **rapid identification of delivery bottlenecks**

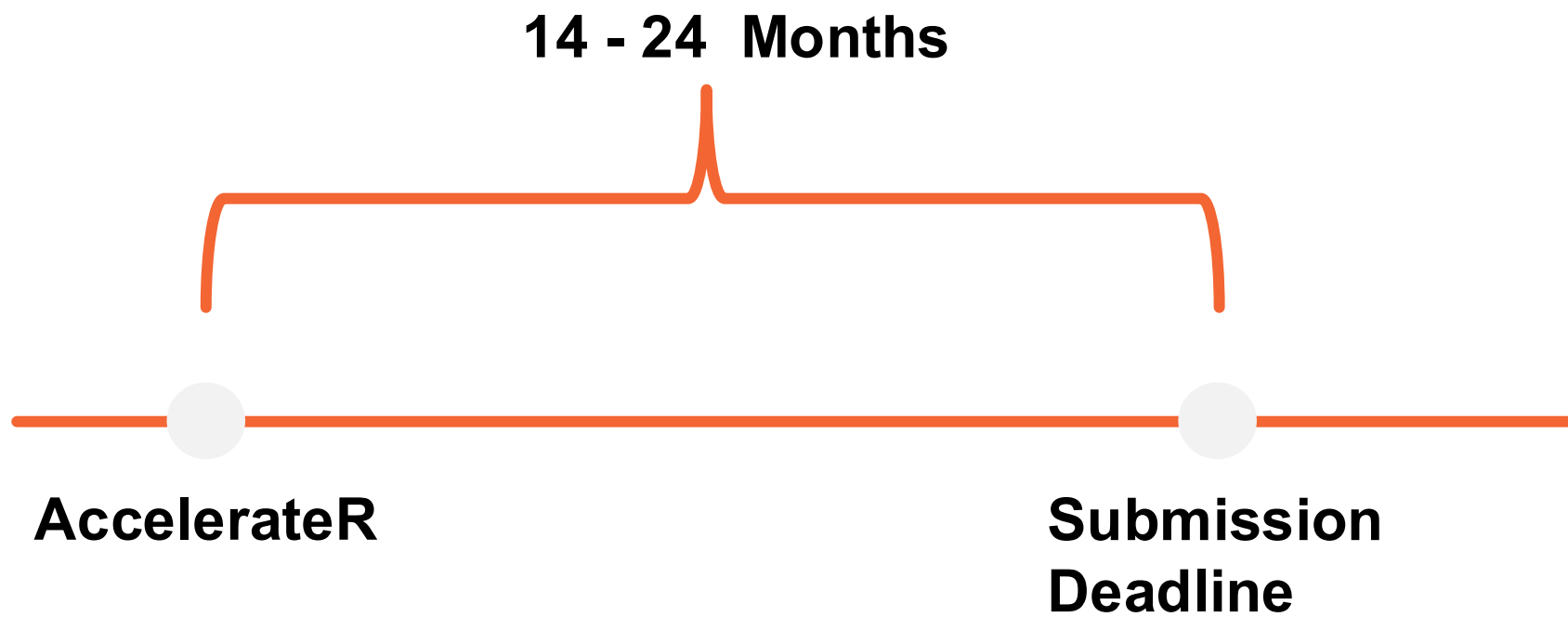


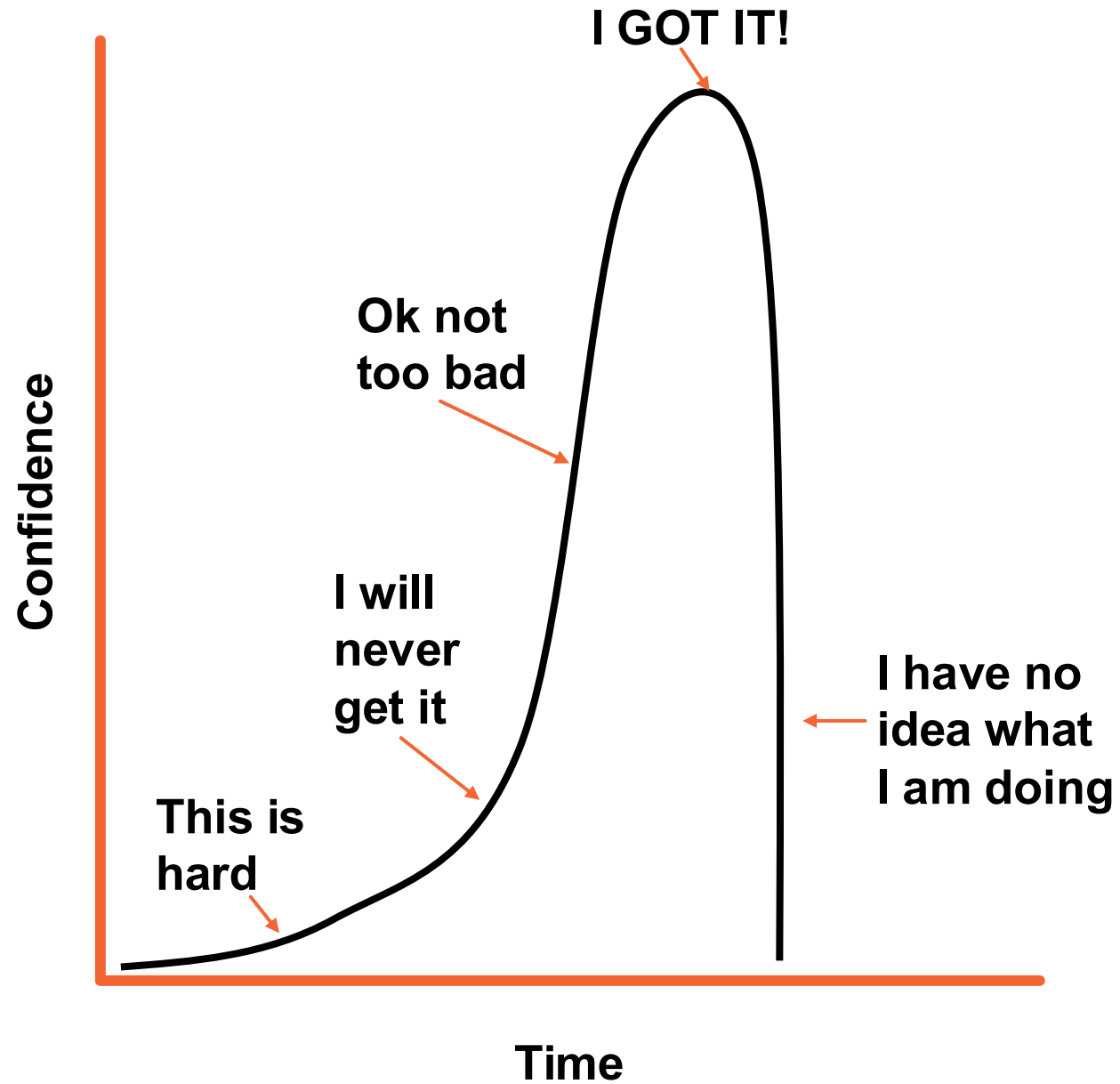




**We encountered
some
challenges...**







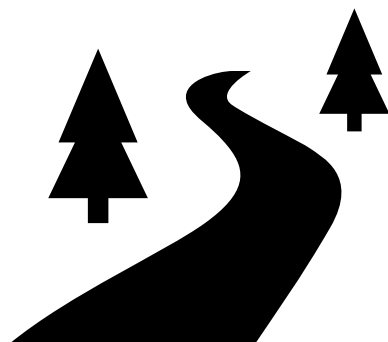
Some things went well



1



2



3





How do organizations enable people to learn by doing with pressing deadlines?

You support them by sitting side by side - using the new tools as they create their deliverables.



A large, flowing orange shape that starts wide on the left and tapers towards the right, creating a sense of movement and depth.

Thank You!

GSK